

Belgium

Ratio: 13:15 **Adopted:** January 23, 1831 **Usage:** National and Civil

The vertical layout is derived from the French *Tricolore*



Red is adapted from the lions claws and tongue

Black is taken from the shield of the arms

Gold is the color of the lion in the arms

Europe



Following centuries of foreign domination, **Belgium** finally gained international recognition as an independent kingdom in 1830.

The Belgian colors black, yellow and red derive from the arms of Brabant, a black shield with a gold lion having red tongue and claws. The first flag in these colors, but with horizontal

stripes, appeared in 1792 in a revolt against Austrian rule. On independence in 1831, they were changed to vertical in imitation of the French *Tricolore*.

Belgian Regional flags



BRUSSELS

Adopted in 1991, the lily was widespread in the area which later became Brussels.



FLANDERS

Adopted in 1985, it is based on the arms, and the colors are taken from the national flag.



GERMAN REGION

Adopted in 1990, the lion recalls former owner, Limburg; 9 roses are for the 9 communes.



WALLONIA

The cockerel is derived from the Gallic rooster, recalling the cultural links with France.